

THE gathering

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SIX WEEKS IN EPHESIANS

# Who You Really Are

AGES 4 TO 7

*Simple words. Big truths.  
Fun activities.*

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**The Gathering Kids**

THE GATHERING CTX · CLEBURNE, TEXAS

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*For our partners, with gratitude*

# WHAT IS INSIDE

*Six weeks of simple truths for little hearts. Read it together. Do the activity. Say the words out loud.*

*That is the whole plan.*

## God Picked You!

Ephesians 1

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## Jesus Brought You Close!

Ephesians 2

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## You're in God's Family!

Ephesians 3

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## Be Who You Are!

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## Shine Like a Light!

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## Put On Your Armor!

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# God Picked You!

EPHESIANS 1

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**Big Idea** God chose YOU to be in His family!

## Memory Verse

*"He chose us." Ephesians 1:4*

## THE STORY

Have you ever been picked for a team? It feels SO good to hear your name called!

Guess what? Before God made the world, before the stars and the sun and the animals, God thought about YOU. And He said: "I pick that one! That one is going to be in my family!"

God didn't wait to see if you were going to be good. He picked you because He LOVES you. You are chosen. You are wanted. You belong to God!

## ASK YOUR CHILD

- How does it feel when someone picks you to be on their team?

- Did you know God picked YOU to be in His family?

#### **ACTIVITY: CHOSEN HEART**

Draw a big heart. Write your child's name inside it. Around the heart write: "CHOSEN BY GOD." Decorate it together and hang it in their room.

#### **SAY TOGETHER**

God picked me! I am chosen! I am loved! I am in God's family!

#### **PRAY TOGETHER**

Dear God, thank You for picking me! Thank You for loving me! I love You too. Amen.

# Jesus Brought You Close!

EPHESIANS 2

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**Big Idea** We were far from God, but Jesus brought us close!

## Memory Verse

*"God made us alive." Ephesians 2:5*

## THE STORY

Imagine you were lost in a big forest, far away from home. You couldn't find your way back. You tried and tried, but you were stuck.

Then someone came to rescue you! They found you, picked you up, and carried you all the way home.

That's what Jesus did for us! We were far away from God, and we couldn't get to Him on our own. But Jesus came and found us. He brought us close. Now we are HOME with God!

### ASK YOUR CHILD

- Have you ever been lost? How did it feel when someone found you?
- Who brought us close to God? (Jesus!)

### ACTIVITY: CLOSE HUG

Stand far apart from each other across the room. Then run together and give a big hug! Say: "We were FAR, but Jesus brought us CLOSE!" Do it a few times. It's fun!

### SAY TOGETHER

I was far away, but Jesus brought me close! I am alive! I am home with God!

### PRAY TOGETHER

Dear Jesus, thank You for finding me and bringing me close to God. I love being in Your family! Amen.

# You're in God's Family!

EPHESIANS 3

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**Big Idea** Everyone who loves Jesus is in God's big family!

## Memory Verse

*"God can do more than we ask." Ephesians 3:20*

## THE STORY

Do you know what a family is? People who love each other and belong together!

God has a really BIG family. Everyone who loves Jesus is part of it! It doesn't matter if you're big or small, young or old. If you love Jesus, you're IN!

And here's something amazing: God can do MORE than you can even think of! More than you can imagine! More than you can dream! God is SO big and SO powerful, and He loves YOU!

### ASK YOUR CHILD

- Who is in God's family? (Everyone who loves Jesus!)
- What's the biggest thing you can imagine? God can do even MORE than that!

### ACTIVITY: FAMILY PORTRAIT

Draw a picture of your family. Then draw a big circle around it and write "GOD'S FAMILY" on top. Talk about how you're part of God's even BIGGER family!

### SAY TOGETHER

I am in God's family! God loves me! God can do MORE than I can even imagine!

### PRAY TOGETHER

Dear God, thank You that I'm in Your family!  
Thank You that You can do big things! I love You!  
Amen.

# Be Who You Are!

EPHESIANS 4

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**Big Idea** Be kind, tell the truth, and act like God's kid!

## Memory Verse

*"Be kind to one another." Ephesians 4:32*

## THE STORY

When you get dressed in the morning, you put on clean clothes, right? You don't wear dirty, stinky clothes!

God wants us to "put on" good things too. Not clothes, but the way we ACT. Put on kindness! Put on telling the truth! Put on sharing! Put on forgiving!

And take OFF the yucky stuff. Take off being mean. Take off lying. Take off being selfish.

You're God's kid! Act like it!

### ASK YOUR CHILD

- What are some kind things you can do today?
- Why is it important to tell the truth?

### ACTIVITY: PUT ON / TAKE OFF

Play a game! Say something and have your child say "PUT ON!" (if it's good) or "TAKE OFF!" (if it's bad). Examples: Kindness (Put on!), Lying (Take off!), Sharing (Put on!), Hitting (Take off!), Forgiving (Put on!).

### SAY TOGETHER

I am God's kid! I put on kindness! I tell the truth!  
I forgive! I act like who I am!

### PRAY TOGETHER

Dear God, help me be kind and tell the truth.  
Help me act like Your kid today! Amen.

# Shine Like a Light!

EPHESIANS 5

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**Big Idea** You are God's light! Shine bright!

## Memory Verse

*"Walk as children of light." Ephesians 5:8*

## THE STORY

What happens when you turn on a light in a dark room? The darkness goes away!

Guess what? YOU are like a light! When you are kind, when you love people, when you tell the truth, you SHINE! And the darkness goes away.

God says: "You are light!" Not "try to be light."  
You ARE light because Jesus lives in you. So shine bright today!

## ASK YOUR CHILD

- What happens when you turn on a light in a dark room?

- How can YOU shine like a light today?

#### **ACTIVITY: FLASHLIGHT FUN**

Turn off the lights and sit in the dark. Give your child a flashlight and let them turn it on. Watch how ONE light changes everything! Say: "You are like this light! Everywhere you go, you can shine!"

#### **SAY TOGETHER**

I am a child of light! I shine bright! Jesus lives in me! I walk in love!

#### **PRAY TOGETHER**

Dear God, thank You that I am a light! Help me shine bright for You today. I love You! Amen.

# Put On Your Armor!

EPHESIANS 6

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**Big Idea** God gives you special armor to be strong and brave!

## Memory Verse

*"Be strong in the Lord." Ephesians 6:10*

## THE STORY

Have you ever seen a knight in shiny armor? Knights wear armor to protect them and keep them safe!

Guess what? God gives YOU armor too! Not armor made of metal, but special armor that helps you be strong and brave.

God gives you truth to protect you from lies. He gives you His love to keep your heart safe. He gives you His Word like a special sword! When you feel scared or sad, you can remember: God made you strong!

### ASK YOUR CHILD

- What does a knight wear to stay safe?  
(Armor!)
- Who makes YOU strong and brave? (God!)

### ACTIVITY: SUPERHERO POSE

Stand up tall like a superhero! Put your hands on your hips. Say together: "I am STRONG in the LORD!" Do your best superhero pose. God made you brave!

### SAY TOGETHER

I am strong in the Lord! God keeps me safe! I am brave because God is with me!

### PRAY TOGETHER

Dear God, thank You for making me strong and brave! Help me remember that You are always with me. I love You! Amen.

TAKE THE JOURNEY WITH YOU

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